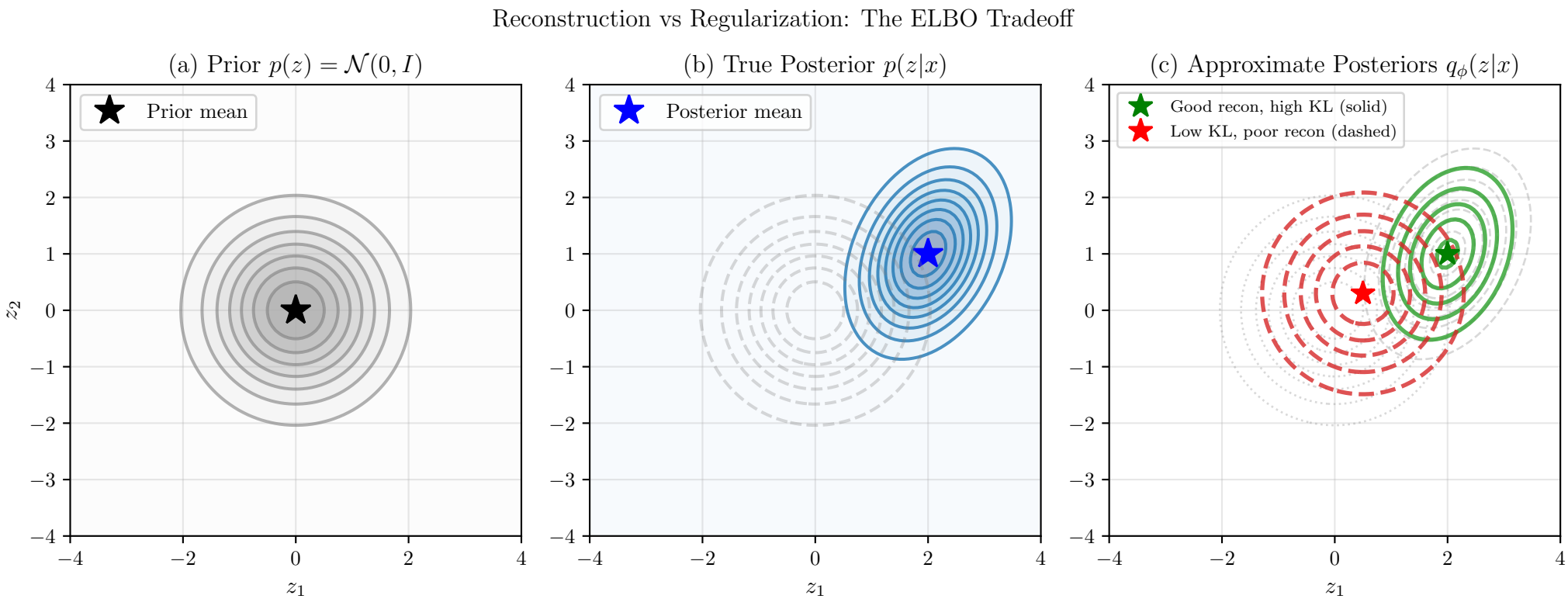
Reconstruction vs Regularization: The ELBO Tradeoff
(a) Prior $p(z) = \mathcal{N}(0, I)$
Prior mean
(b) True Posterior $p(z|x)$
Posterior mean
(c) Approximate Posteriors $q_\phi(z|x)$
Good recon, high KL (solid)
Low KL, poor recon (dashed)
z_1
z_2